

Kyle Nissen

Technical Game Designer

Calgary, AB
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Professional Profile

Game designer and programmer with 10+ years of experience building and shipping gameplay systems across PC, console, and mobile. Capable of deep systems thinking, procedural design, and multiplayer architecture with the technical depth to own features from concept through implementation in Unreal Engine 5. A former two time Olympic athlete who brings the same discipline and standards to collaborative development.

Education

- **Bachelor of Computer Science** with concentration in Video Game Design from the University of Calgary, 2014. Member of Faculty of Science Dean's List for final term.
- Minor in Management and Society.

Core Design Competencies

Systemic & Procedural Game Design • Feature Design & GDD Documentation • Gameplay Scripting & Prototyping (UE5 Blueprints) • Multiplayer Design & Replication • Gameplay Tuning & Balancing • Cross-Discipline Collaboration • Unreal Engine 5 (PCG, Blueprints, C++) • Unity (8+ years)

Work Experience

Box Cutter Games, Founder - June 2024 - November 2025

- Founded Box Cutter Games with the goal of creating industry-leading multiplayer experiences grounded in strong design and technical innovation.
- Sole designer and technical lead on an original multiplayer space-physics game built in UE5.5.
- Designed all core gameplay systems: zero-gravity movement, procedural spacecraft and salvage system driven by the PCG framework.
- Authored full GDDs and system design documents for all features; iterated rapidly using Blueprints before committing to C++ implementations.
- Architected multiplayer-ready systems including replication-safe inventory, physics interactions, and session management.

Vivid Helix, Game Prototype development - Feb 2024 - Apr 2024

- Created 2D audio based game prototype using Unity 2022 and FMOD audio middleware.
- Focused on rapid iteration and responding to designer feedback to quickly test ideas and develop features and ideas.

New World Interactive, Gameplay Programmer Sep 2023 - Dec 2023

- Worked on unannounced tactical FPS built in Unreal 5.1.
- Created an Unreal plugin for tracking game events for player statistics and player progression and rewards.
- Performed code reviews on other team members' code. Worked with continuous integration toolset including: Unreal Game Sync, Rider for Unreal, Perforce.
- Collaborated closely with design and UI disciplines to surface player data in-game.

Isto Inc., Senior Programmer, Designer - Feb 2018 - Feb 2023

- Led implementation of all systems code and co-authored design on **Atrio: The Dark Wild**, a systems-driven survival/automation game on PC and Xbox.
- Designed and built a massive-scale automation system supporting 100,000+ simultaneous simulation elements; balanced the entire economy and progression loop.
- Authored game design documentation, defined core gameplay pillars, and iterated on mechanics based on community feedback throughout playtests and Early Access.
- Owned all gameplay scripting, AI behaviour, audio design, and UI — serving as both a creative and technical voice on the project.

Zugalu, Games Developer & Gameplay Designer - Sep 2016 - Jan 2018

- Designed and shipped **Boulder Run** (iOS/Android) and **Flight of the Technolites** (PC/Steam) in a small cross-discipline team using the Unity game engine.
- Responsible for game feel, control tuning, and core loop design on both titles.
- Collaborated directly with artists on visual-design feedback.

Copper Brain, Lead Developer - Jan 2015 - Aug 2016

- Designer and lead programmer on **Disjoint**, a unique 2D/3D puzzle game on iOS and Android. Achieved #1 paid app ranking on both stores with a 4.9-star rating.
- Involved in all aspects of game design and development. Primary areas of work are in game mechanics and user interaction, ensuring intuitive controls and smooth, tight gameplay, code base quality and source control repository.

Volunteer and Community

Calgary Game Developers Association

- Non-profit organization dedicated to the promotion and support of local game creators in the city
- Active member since June 2016, Board member 2021-2023.
- 8 year participant in Game Critique, a monthly workshop analyzing games and their design.
- Presenter at meetups on various topics, including PCG in Unreal, FMOD audio and game design topics
- Indiecade participant, porting games to custom built arcade cabinets used around the city to promote local games and the association.